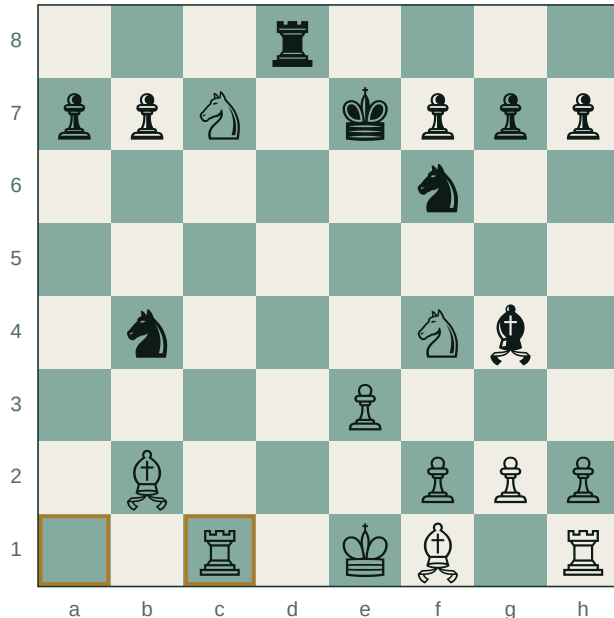


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 18

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 18.Rc1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

18...Nc2+ 19. Rxc2 Rd1#

18...Nc2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **19.Rxc2**.

19...Rd1# Mate: rook on d1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on e1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on d1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b2 and rook on h1. Check for tactical protection.